

INDUS

THE INDIAN

INTRODUCED TO THE SOUTHERN SKY IN THE 16TH CENTURY, THIS CONSTELLATION REPRESENTS AN INDIAN, ALTHOUGH IT IS UNCLEAR WHETHER THIS REFERS TO A NATIVE OF THE AMERICAS OR ASIA.

Indus is one of the 12 figures invented by Dutch navigators Pieter Dirkszoon Keyser and Frederick de Houtman, who charted the sky of the Southern Hemisphere during the 1590s. The Indian figure carries a spear and arrows, and is drawn around three stars that form a right angle in the northern part of the constellation. Indus's brightest stars are of 3rd-magnitude and it has no significant star clusters or nebulae. One notable star is Epsilon Indi, a yellow main-sequence, magnitude-4.7 star just 11.2 light-years away, making it one of the closest stars to us.

▷ ESO 77-14

The once-flat disks of two similar-sized galaxies have become distorted and the pair are connected by material that used to be inside the galaxies. A short, red arm of gas and dust has been pulled out of the top galaxy, the lower galaxy has a longer bluish arm.



Alpha (α) Indi

An orange giant about 12 times the width of the Sun and with 100 times its luminosity. Its two companions can be seen with a medium-sized telescope

Beta (β) Indi

The second-brightest star in this constellation, Beta is an orange giant of magnitude 3.7, and is 600 light-years away

NGC 7090

A spiral galaxy seen edge-on and about 30 million light-years away. It was discovered by British astronomer John Herschel in 1834

KEY DATA

Size ranking 49

Brightest stars Alpha (α) 3.1, Beta (β) 3.7

Genitive Indi

Abbreviation Ind

Highest in sky at 10pm August–October

Fully visible 15°N–90°S



CHART 2

MAIN STARS

Alpha (α) Indi
Orange giant

☼ 3.1 ↔ 98 light-years

Beta (β) Indi
Orange giant

☼ 3.7 ↔ 610 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

NGC 7049

Lenticular galaxy

NGC 7090

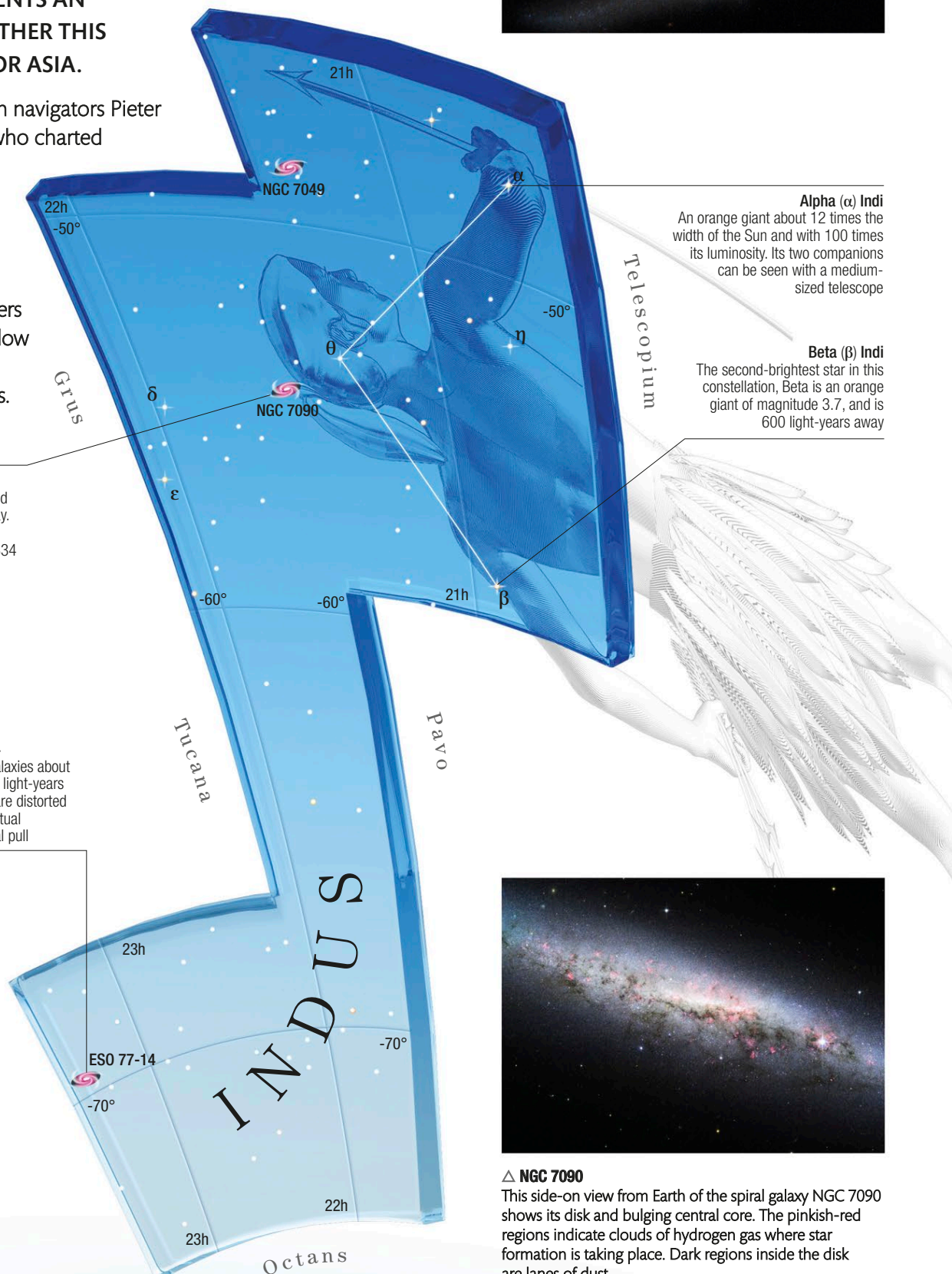
Spiral galaxy

ESO 77-14

A pair of interacting galaxies

ESO 77-14

A pair of galaxies about 550 million light-years away that are distorted by their mutual gravitational pull



△ NGC 7090

This side-on view from Earth of the spiral galaxy NGC 7090 shows its disk and bulging central core. The pinkish-red regions indicate clouds of hydrogen gas where star formation is taking place. Dark regions inside the disk are lanes of dust.